has described as a 'cold peace'.[34] The determined, responsible pursuit of power is the challenge ahead.

Will India embark on such a course? Perhaps, but much will depend on how desperately Indians want to be powerful. Nye's work on the components of power – hard power (economic and military capabilities) and soft power (the ability to attract and persuade) – misses a key element of power: the *desire* for power and a channelling of social effort towards the attainment of power. This desire for power is part of the argument of Manjari Chatterjee Miller's new book, *Why Nations Rise: Narratives and the Path to Great Power*.[35] Indians after the economic reforms of 1991 have in some measure developed a desire for power – 'in some measure' because the preoccupation of tens of millions of Indians is with the challenges of daily survival and betterment. The desire for power is therefore largely restricted to an urban elite. In any case, though, the will to power is not simply a matter of burning desire. It also requires a systematic social effort led by the government to 'produce' power. Great Powers arose in the past without the will to power: the population did not necessarily thirst for power, and the government did not have a clear and dedicated plan for power. The rise to power 'happened'. Modern mass societies, since Napoleon, have been different. If they have had a will to power, it is because popular and government ambitions were fused.

What was the key turning point? In all probability it was the emergence of total war. Total war is the mobilization of a nation's entire resources and population in the service of warfare. Europe increasingly fought total wars after Napoleon. The US and Russia (and later the USSR) in their time experienced total war: the US in its civil war, and Russia and the USSR after the 1917 revolutions. In Asia, the first country to prepare for and fight total war was Japan, beginning in the early twentieth century. China followed, living with total war from its republican and then communist revolutions to the fight against Japan from 1937 onward. Most of Asia was a theatre of total war in the sense that it was thrown into the midst of the Second World War and lived through the Japanese occupation. It is only